

Conflict De-Escalation Scripts

Module 13 — Print and Keep Accessible

CONFLICT: "You're trying to control everything!"

✗ "I'm doing all the work while you do nothing!"

✓ "I know this feels overwhelming. Let's divide the tasks so everyone has a clear role. What would you like to be responsible for?"

CONFLICT: "Mom doesn't need to move yet."

✗ "You're in denial!"

✓ "I understand you want to protect Mom's independence. Can we agree on specific safety benchmarks that would trigger a move?"

CONFLICT: "You're wasting Mom's money!"

✗ "You don't understand the situation!"

✓ "Let's review the costs together and make sure we're all on the same page about priorities and budget."

CONFLICT: "You don't care — you never visit."

✗ "You don't do anything either!"

✓ "I know I can't be there as often. What tasks can I handle remotely so the load is more balanced?"

CONFLICT: "Dad would never want this."

✗ "You don't know what Dad wants!"

✓ "You're right that Dad's wishes matter most. Let's go back to what he's actually told us and use that as our guide."

CONFLICT: "This is too expensive."

✗ "You're being cheap with Mom's safety!"

✓ "Let's look at the numbers together. What's the cost of doing this vs. the cost of not doing it?"

THE PATTERN: Acknowledge the feeling → Redirect to a shared goal → Invite collaboration. Never argue the feeling.
